

Downsizing for Seniors - Printable Worksheets

From *Downsizing for Seniors* by Ruth Callahan (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

Worksheet 1 - Stay or go: the comparison

Score each line out of 5, one column for you and one for your partner if there is one.

	This house, changed (cost of the change)	Score me	Score partner	The new home	Score me	Score partner
Stairs and bathroom						
Shops, doctor, bus						
Garden and outside jobs						
Running costs a year						
Distance from family and friends						
Neighbours and company						
Room for visitors; for a carer one day						
Safety alone						
The money (Worksheet 3)						
How it feels						
Totals						

Worksheet 2 - The options grid

Place visited	Type	Price or rent	Service charge / fees a month	What it rises by	Care available?	Walk to shops (min)	Distance to family	Visited (weekday / weekend)	Score / 10

Worksheet 3 - The downsizing sum

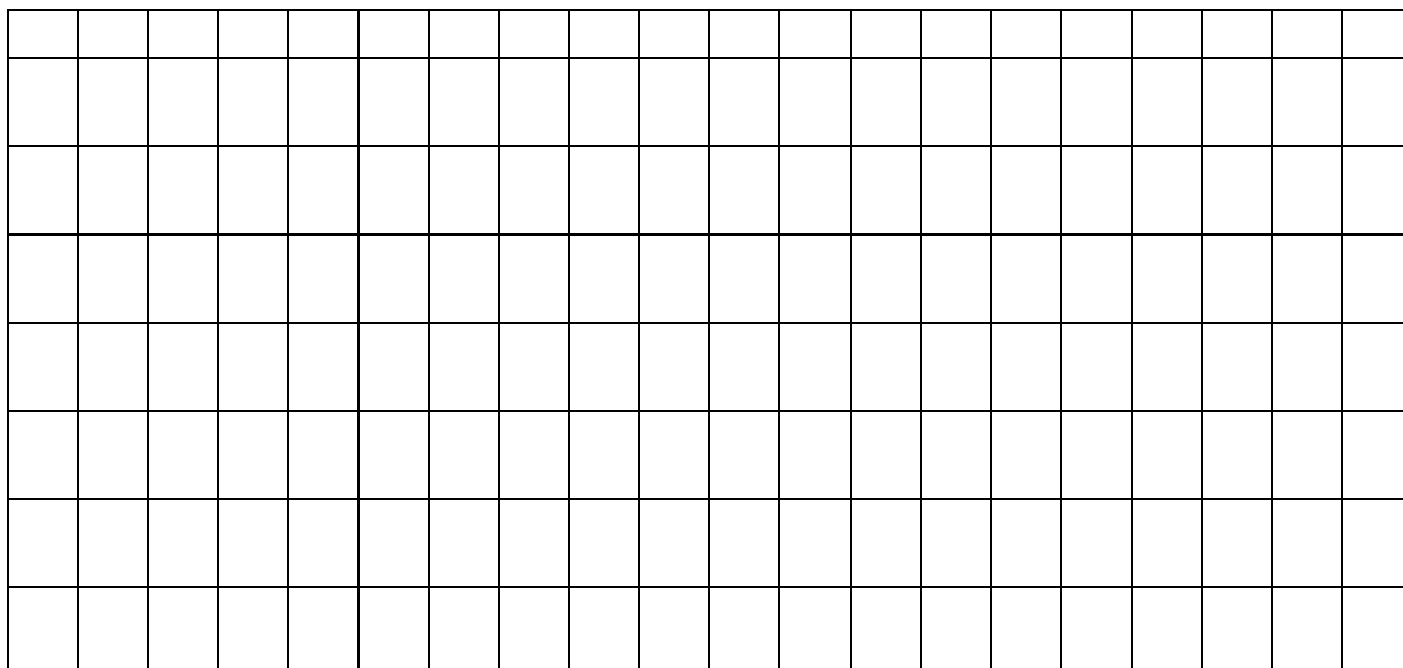
	Amount
The house will sell for about	
Less the mortgage or equity release owed	
Less selling, moving and clearing costs	
Less the new home's price (or deposit) and buying costs	
Money released	
New home running costs a year	
Old house running costs a year	
Saving (or extra cost) a year	
Money released x 3 to 4 per cent a year	
Change in yearly income	
Notes (tax on the gain, downsizer contribution, advice taken)	

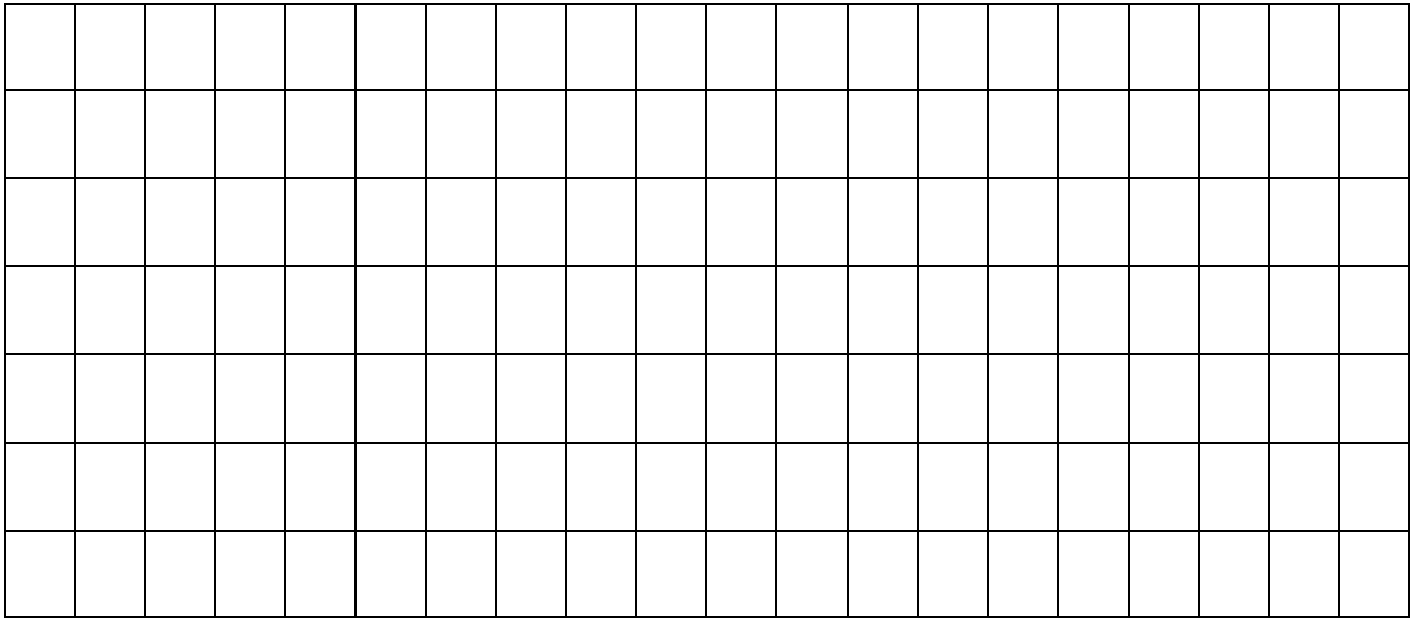
Worksheet 4 - The timeline

Month	The home	The stuff	The paper	Done
1 (date:)	Comparison, options, sum; three visits; tell the family	Sessions start: attic, garage, spare room	Deeds, mortgage, insurance found; three valuations	
2 (date:)	New home chosen; finance; floor plan measured	Furniture list; a room a week	Lawyer chosen; address list started	
3 (date:)	House on the market; move manager or family booked	First wave sold and donated	Three removal quotes; insurance checked	
4 (date:)	Offer accepted; dates agreed with a gap	Second wave: estate sale, auction, charity van	Utilities, bank, pension, doctor told; boxes ordered	
5 (date:)	Movers confirmed; keys, cleaner, readings arranged	Non-essentials packed and labelled; first-night box	Post redirected; records transferred; new doctor	
6 (date:)	Moving week; first night; first week	Bedroom, bathroom, kitchen unpacked	Final readings; keys returned; last changes	

Worksheet 5 - The floor plan grid

One square = 1 foot (or 30 cm). Draw the new home's rooms, doors, windows, radiators and sockets; cut furniture shapes from Worksheet 6 to the same scale.





Worksheet 6 - The furniture list

[illegible]

Worksheet 7 - The room-by-room checklist

Week	Room	Sessions done	Keep boxes	Give (to whom,	Sell (listed / sold)	Gone (charity /	Finished
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				collected?)		recycling / bin)	
1	Attic, garage, shed, under- stairs						
2	Spare room, hall cupboards						
3	Kitchen						
4	Bathroom, linen, medicines						
5	Bedroom and wardrobe						
6	Living and dining rooms						
7	Paper						
8	Sentimental things						

Worksheet 8 - The sell, donate and give log

Item	Route (estate sale / auction / online / consignment / charity / family)	Listed or offered on	Price asked	Sold or collected on	Received	Notes

Worksheet 9 - The change-of-address list

Who	Account or reference	Told on	Confirmed	Notes
Post office redirection				
Bank(s)				
Credit cards				

Savings and investments				
Pension(s); state pension / Social Security				
Tax office				
Electoral register				
Driving licence; vehicle registration				
Health service / Medicare; benefits				
Doctor; dentist; optician; pharmacy; clinics				
Home insurance (both homes); car; life; pet; travel				
Gas; electricity; water; phone; broadband; television				
Council / property tax; refuse				
Subscriptions; memberships; clubs; church; charities				
Family and friends; the card list				
Vet; microchip register				
Lawyer; executor; the will				
Alarm company; key holder; tradespeople				

Worksheet 10 - The moving-day plan

Date; completion time; key handover arrangements	
Movers: firm, phone, arrival time, crew size, what is included	
Who is at the old house; who is at the new	
Pet and children: where they are for the day	
The first-night box and the important papers folder: in whose car	
Meter readings (old): gas / electricity / water, with photographs	
Final walk-round: loft, garage, shed, cupboards, behind doors, garden	
Keys left: where, for whom	
At the new home: beds first, kettle second, bathroom third	
Meter readings (new)	
The evening meal: from where	
Who is staying the first night, or phoning	

Worksheet 11 - The first-night box

Item	Packed
Medicines and the medicines list; glasses; hearing aid batteries	
The important papers folder; keys (old and new); phone and charger	

Nightwear; a change of clothes; toiletries; towels	
Bedding for every bed, or the beds made before the van leaves	
Kettle, mugs, tea, coffee, milk, biscuits; a knife; plates and cutlery for two	
Toilet paper; soap; a torch; a lamp and bulb; scissors; the bed tool	
Pet food, bowl, lead, litter	
A little cash; the movers' contract; the new home's instructions	
The card with the new address for anyone who asks	

Worksheet 12 - The first-month checklist

Task	Done
Bedroom, bathroom and kitchen unpacked	
Stopcock, fuse box, boiler, thermostat, meters found and labelled	
Smoke alarms tested; grab rails, night lights, stair and step lighting checked	
Registered with the doctor; pharmacy found; prescriptions moved	
Shop, cafe and bus stop walked in daylight	
Neighbours met	
Broadband and television working	
Post redirection working	

Pictures on the walls	
Important papers in their place; will and powers of attorney reviewed	
One community activity, or one club, joined	
The helpers thanked	

